

PPC Campaign Launch Checklist

A practical checklist covering campaign architecture, targeting, conversion tracking, ad creative, and pre-launch QA before spending ad budget.

1. Campaign Strategy & Account Structure

- ☐ Align campaign structure with specific business goals (Lead Gen vs E-commerce vs Brand).
- ☐ Separate Search, Performance Max, Display, and Retargeting campaigns with isolated budgets.
- ☐ Group keywords into tightly themed Ad Groups (max 5-10 related keywords per group).
- ☐ Configure precise location targeting (set to 'Presence: People in or regularly in your target locations').

2. Keyword Strategy & Match Types

- ☐ Use Exact [keyword] and Phrase "keyword" match types for controlled intent capture.
- ☐ Build a shared Master Negative Keyword List (free, cheap, jobs, login, torrent, etc.).
- ☐ Audit search term reports to identify emerging queries and negative candidates.

3. Ad Copy & Assets (Extensions)

- ☐ Write 3+ Responsive Search Ads (RSAs) per ad group with dynamic keyword insertion.
- ☐ Utilize all available headline slots (15) and description lines (4) focusing on value & proof.
- ☐ Add all relevant ad assets: Sitelinks, Callouts, Structured Snippets, Call, and Lead Forms.

4. Landing Page Experience & Conversion Rate Optimization

- ☐ Ensure 1:1 message match between ad headline and landing page hero copy.
- ☐ Optimize mobile load speed (page loads in under 2.5 seconds on 4G networks).
- ☐ Place primary lead capture form above the fold with clear value propositions and trust badges.
- ☐ Eliminate distracting navigation links on dedicated landing pages.

5. Tracking, Tagging & Pre-Launch QA

- ☐ Verify Google Tag Manager (GTM) and Google Analytics 4 (GA4) integration.
- ☐ Test conversion tags using Google Tag Assistant to confirm firing upon form submission.
- ☐ Enable Enhanced Conversions in Google Ads for improved conversion attribution.
- ☐ Perform live test conversion in staging to verify data flows into CRM properly.

6. Bidding & Budget Safety

- ☐ Start with Maximize Clicks with Max CPC bid cap, or Manual CPC for initial data gathering.
- ☐ Set conservative initial daily budgets to prevent unexpected budget depletion on Day 1.
- ☐ Set up automated rules/alerts for sudden spend spikes or zero-impression ad groups.